

Video Game Maker Nintendo to Open a Museum

The Japanese video game company Nintendo is opening a museum that will teach visitors about its history.

At the museum, fans of Super Mario, The Legend of Zelda and the Game Boy and Switch devices can learn more about one of the world's most famous game makers.

The museum is in Uji near the company's Kyoto headquarters.

It will show the many developments of Nintendo, which was founded in 1889. The company began as a maker of "hanafuda" playing cards and has since grown to offer many kinds of electronic games.

A general view of the Nintendo Museum during a press preview in Uji, Kyoto Prefecture, western Japan September 25, 2024. (REUTERS/Irene Wang)

Shigeru Miyamoto is an executive fellow at Nintendo and the creator of Super Mario. Miyamoto said the museum was meant to deepen understanding of the company.

"If making products while protecting concepts such as family, fun and ease of understanding is rooted in our employees then the new Nintendo will continue to grow," he told reporters recently.

The museum, which opens to the public October 2, is in the place where the company used to make playing cards and was a center for product repairs. On its website, tickets to the museum are sold out for two months after the opening.

In addition to showing famous devices such as the Wii console and the handheld Game Boy, visitors will be able to see lesser-known products. These include the MamabERICA baby stroller and the Copilas printer.

The museum also offers special experiences. Visitors, for example, will be able to work together to play the video game Super Mario Bros. on an oversized Family Computer controller.

This photo taken on September 24, 2024 shows visitors interacting with a game during a media preview of the new Nintendo Museum, located inside a renovated old factory, in the suburbs of Kyoto. (Photo by Richard A. Brooks / AFP)

The company's push into mobile gaming has dropped off. But other efforts by Nintendo to grow beyond its main, or core, gaming business have made progress. The company has been opening stores and employing its characters in theme parks and movies.

The Switch console has been a major success with over 140 million devices in use. But, with sales slowing, investor attention is now on the possibility for a new device.

Nintendo aims to announce details of a possible new device in the current financial year, which ends in March.

I'm John Russell.

Sam Nussey and Irene Wang reported on this story for Reuters. John Russell adapted it for VOA Learning English.

Vocabulary

museum - n. สถานที่ที่จัดแสดงวัตถุต่างๆ หรือสิ่งของต่างๆ

concept - n. แนวคิด นามธรรม หรือความคิดทั่วไป

ticket - n. หลักฐานที่เป็นกระดาษหรือดิจิทัลที่แสดงว่าคุณได้ชำระเงินสำหรับการเข้าชมสถานที่ เช่น พิพิธภัณฑ์ การแสดง ภาพยนตร์ หรือการแข่งขันกีฬาหรืองานดนตรี

stroller - n. รถเข็นเด็กชนิดหนึ่งที่ออกแบบเป็นเก้าอี้สำหรับเข็นเด็กเล็ก

character - n. ตัวละครที่ปรากฏในหนังสือ ภาพยนตร์ หรือวิดีโอเกม

theme park - n. สวนสนุกที่มีเครื่องเล่น กิจกรรม และสินค้าที่อิงตามผลิตภัณฑ์ เช่น ภาพยนตร์ หรือวิดีโอเกม

Reading Comprehension Quiz

1. What is Nintendo primarily doing according to the article's beginning?

- A) Releasing a new video game console.
- B) Expanding its mobile gaming division.
- C) Opening a museum to showcase its history.
- D) Announcing a new financial year strategy.

2. Which of the following is NOT explicitly mentioned as a famous Nintendo creation fans can learn about at the museum?

- A) Super Mario
- B) The Legend of Zelda
- C) Pokémon
- D) Game Boy

3. Where is the new Nintendo Museum situated?

- A) In Kyoto, within the company's headquarters.

- B) In Uji, close to Nintendo's main office.
- C) In an unspecified city in western Japan.
- D) Near the location where hanafuda cards were made.

4. What was Nintendo's initial business when it was founded?

- A) Manufacturing electronic games.
- B) Developing video game consoles.
- C) Producing "hanafuda" playing cards.
- D) Repairing consumer electronics.

5. In what year was Nintendo originally established?

- A) 1989
- B) 1889
- C) 2024
- D) 1990

6. What is Shigeru Miyamoto's primary association with Nintendo, as stated in the text?

- A) He is the current CEO of the company.
- B) He is an executive fellow and the creator of Super Mario.
- C) He is responsible for all new device announcements.
- D) He designed the museum building.

7. According to Shigeru Miyamoto, which of the following concepts is essential for Nintendo's continued growth?

- A) Aggressive market expansion and acquisition.
- B) Financial investment and investor relations.
- C) Family, fun, and ease of understanding in product creation.
- D) Exclusive partnerships with other tech companies.

8. Before becoming a museum, the building had two previous functions. What were they?

- A) A video game development studio and a retail store.
- B) A playing card factory and a product repair center.
- C) A corporate headquarters and a research lab.
- D) A distribution warehouse and an arcade.

9. What does the article indicate about the initial demand for Nintendo Museum tickets?

- A) They are readily available for purchase.

- B) They are sold out for the first two months.
- C) They require a special invitation for entry.
- D) Sales have been slow since the opening.

10. Which of these products is NOT mentioned as being on display at the Nintendo Museum?

- A) Wii console
- B) Game Boy
- C) Nintendo DS
- D) MamabERICA baby stroller

11. What unique interactive experience can visitors enjoy at the museum?

- A) Designing their own video games.
- B) Competing in professional esports tournaments.
- C) Playing Super Mario Bros. using an oversized controller.
- D) Virtual reality tours of Nintendo's history.

12. What has been the recent trend for Nintendo's mobile gaming efforts?

- A) It has seen significant growth.
- B) It has been steadily increasing.
- C) It has dropped off.
- D) It is being integrated into theme parks.

13. Besides its core gaming business, what are two other areas where Nintendo is expanding?

- A) Mobile gaming and virtual reality.
- B) Hardware manufacturing and software development.
- C) Retail stores and character usage in theme parks and movies.
- D) Online streaming services and music production.

14. Despite the Switch's success, what is currently happening with its sales?

- A) They are rapidly accelerating.
- B) They have remained consistently high.
- C) They are slowing down.
- D) They have exceeded all expectations.

15. When does Nintendo intend to release information about a potential new device?

- A) Before the end of the calendar year.
- B) In the next financial year, starting in April.
- C) During the current financial year, concluding in March.
- D) As soon as sales of the Switch pick up again.